A-A-1895
July 24, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TAPE, SOUND RECORDING, 1/4-INCH, GENERAL PURPOSE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification W-T-001572.

This commercial item description covers new 1/4-inch audio tape of 1 mil and 1.5 mil thickness, supplied on reels or hubs and intended for general purpose use on audio reel to reel recording and reproducing equipment.

Salient characteristics:

Length. Tape shall be supplied in lengths of 600, 900, 1200, 1800, 2500, 3600, and 7200 feet, as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Thickness. 1 mil and 1.5 mil, as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Yield strength. The 1 percent offset yield point, the force at 3 percent elongation and the breaking force of the tape shall equal or exceed 3.2 pounds for 1 mil tape and 4.9 pounds for 1.5 mil tape.

Frequency response. Within ± 2 db of the response produced by the reference tape at a speed of 7-1/2 inches per second and with operating bias current and standard audio record level.

Audio uniformity. The uniformity of the signal output at test frequencies of 1,000 Hz and 6,000 Hz, when tested as specified below, shall not exceed 2.5 db.

Short term uniformity. The frequencies specified above shall be recorded at standard audio record level and with operating bias current over the entire tape length. On payback, the output voltage variations shall be measured by means of a linear recording oscillograph having a response which is uniform to at least 200 Hz. The tape uniformity shall be measured by determining the maximum variation in output level over any 10 second interval, with all nonrecurring pips being disregarded.

Long term uniformity. The test procedures shall be similar to that specified above. The tape uniformity shall be measured by determining the variation of the peak output over the tape length.

Reels and hubs. Reels and hubs shall perform functionally and shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Toxic compounds. The tape shall not produce toxic effects through inhalation, ingestion, or contact with the skin in normal Government usage.

Workmanship. The magnetic tape shall be manufactured and processed in a careful and workmanlike manner in accordance with good practice. The entire length of the recording tape shall be continuous and splice free, and both the oxide surface and base shall be free from any raised areas, duts, flakes, powder, holes, foreigh matter, scratches, creases, and other defects which would render the tape unsuitable for its intended use.

Quality assurance. All lots offered for delivery must meet the requirements specified herein. The Government may from time to time require inspection of lots offered for delivery in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Special Inspection Level S-2, at an acceptable quality level of 10 percent defective. Failure of samples to comply would result in rejection of material and be cause of further lot by lot inspection.

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product sold in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise providef for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements. The manufacturer shall utilize recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable.

Packaging, packing, and marking. Packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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NOTES: Definition of terms

Reference tape. An unrecorded length of tape (1,200 feet minimum) of the same type the magnetic tape manufacturer wishes to supply, shall be furnished to the General Services Administration for certification that the tape will meet the system performance specifications (including audio frequency response, audio signal-to-noise and audio distortion) of the reference test recorder. When found acceptable, this tape will become the reference tape for that manufacturer's particular product type and it will be used for establishing the operating levels and conditions for the reference test recorder when submitted samples of that particular tape type are evaluated for conformance to the manufacturer's specifications and when tested as specified herein.

Reference test recorder. For the tests specified herein, the General Services Administration will use 3M 400, Ampex AG-440-C, or equivalent audio recorder/reproducers operating at 7-1/2 inches per second.

Operating bias current. The operating bias current is that bias current through the recording head which will give peak output from the reference tape at 400 Hz.

Maximum audio record level. The maximum audio record level is that input level of a 400 Hz sinusoidal signal recorded on the reference tape at operating bias current such that on playback the output signal will be 3 percent third harmonic distortion.

Standard audio record level. The standard audio record level is 12 db below the maximum audio record level.

Copies of MIL-STD-105 are available from Naval Publications and Forms Center, 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120.

MILITARY INTEREST

Military Coordinating Activity:

Air Force - 99

Preparing Activity:

GSA-ADTS

Custodians:

Army - CR
Navy - NV
Air Force - 99

Review Activities:

Defense Electronic Supply Center - ES
U.S. Coast Guard Supply Center - CG

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